

Shaquille Hinds

Senior React Native Engineer · Mobile Architect · Open Source Maintainer

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PROFILE

Senior mobile engineer with 7 years of shipping React Native apps end to end, from solo zero-to-App-Store builds to leading the mobile rewrite of **StudyFetch, an AI learning platform used by 7M+ students**. Specialist in render performance, reusable architecture and developer tooling: **author of 20 open source npm packages**, including a React Native foundation library with 1,000+ monthly downloads that runs in production apps. Owns the whole delivery path, from TypeScript and Node.js services through App Store and Google Play release.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Mobile Engineer | H2 Security

May 2026 – Sep 2026

Remote · Contract

- Lead client engineer and architect for the Academy, a cybersecurity e-learning platform with hands-on coding labs, taking it from concept to working product
- Implemented single sign-on with OpenID Connect (Authorization Code with PKCE) against a self-hosted identity provider, with role-based access for learners, staff and admins
- Turned backend API contracts into complete UI specifications covering every loading, empty, error and permission state, so design and engineering worked from one source of truth

Stack: TypeScript, React, Next.js, Auth.js, OIDC (Zitadel), Django REST API

Senior React Native Engineer | BairesDev (StudyFetch Project)

Jan 2025 – Mar 2026

Remote

- Led the mobile app rewrite for **StudyFetch, an AI learning platform used by 7M+ students**, establishing the architecture, code patterns and file structure adopted across the entire codebase
- Architected real-time lecture transcription and auto-translation using a custom Render Isolated Components pattern (useImperativeHandle), keeping the UI responsive under continuous audio processing by eliminating expensive re-renders
- **Cut boilerplate by 60%** and improved UI consistency by integrating my open source libraries into the production codebase
- Built a responsive layout system on device orientation utilities, delivering a consistent experience across all device sizes
- Owned the full App Store and Google Play release pipeline, from release builds through submission
- Onboarded and mentored new engineers into the codebase's established patterns

Stack: React Native, Expo, TypeScript, Zustand, Reanimated, Cursor

Full Stack Engineer | Path

Sep 2023 – Dec 2024

Remote

- Built an AI-powered learning platform on OpenAI GPT-4 with text-to-speech delivery
- Developed Skills Trainer, a feature that generates dynamic learning modules with AI on demand
- Delivered features end to end across React, TypeScript, Express.js and MongoDB

Stack: React, TypeScript, Node.js, Express.js, OpenAI API, MongoDB

Solo Mobile Engineer (Freelance) | Casuarina

Oct 2022 – Feb 2024

Barbados · Remote

- Designed, built and shipped a thrift shopping marketplace single-handedly, from zero to the App Store
- Architected the React Native client with performance-critical list rendering and optimistic UI updates
- Built the Nest.js backend: catalog, authentication, real-time notifications and payment processing

Stack: React Native, Nest.js, MongoDB, Firebase Cloud Messaging, deep linking

Lead Mobile Engineer | Seventh Ave

Mar 2021 – Mar 2023

Remote

- Hired as a software engineer and grew into the lead mobile role on a social audio platform
- Built live audio rooms end to end: the React Native experience and the Socket.io server behind real-time room communication
- Architected the feed system supporting multimedia posts with full engagement features
- Built anonymous Q&A with multi-format responses and content moderation

Stack: React Native, TypeScript, Node.js, Nest.js, Socket.io, MongoDB, Redis

Founder & Solo Engineer | Merchive

Sep 2019 – Mar 2021

Barbados

- Founded, built and launched an e-commerce platform from scratch, with real-time messaging and Redis caching
- Containerized with Docker and deployed on GCP with Kubernetes for scalable infrastructure

Stack: Next.js, React, Express.js, MongoDB, Redis, Docker, Kubernetes, GCP

OPEN SOURCE

Maintainer of 20 published npm packages built to remove recurring friction in mobile development.

- **react-native-essentials:** foundation library of layouts, typography, hooks, providers and MMKV storage utilities. **1,000+ downloads a month**, 170+ releases, and ships its own AI agent rules installer so coding agents use the library correctly
- **smooth-modal and UI suite:** gesture-driven bottom sheet, modal, dropdown and in-app notification components built on Reanimated and Gesture Handler
- **Developer tooling:** tscodinject (TypeScript code injection), log-location-injector, and CLI scaffolders for navigators, Redux stores and HTTP transports
- **Teaching:** creator of the Render Isolated Components pattern, explained in [Stop Unnecessary Re-renders With This React Pattern](#) (YouTube)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Mobile & Frontend: React Native, Expo, React, Next.js, TypeScript, Reanimated, Gesture Handler, Zustand, Redux, TanStack Query

Backend & Infrastructure: Node.js, Nest.js, Express, MongoDB, Redis, Socket.io, REST, GraphQL, OIDC

DevOps & Cloud: Docker, Kubernetes, GCP, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, App Center, Fastlane), store releases

Quality & Tooling: Jest, React Native Testing Library, npm publishing, AI-assisted dev (Cursor, Claude Code)

ADDITIONAL

Availability: Immediately available. Remote first; open to on-site relocation with visa sponsorship.

Nationality: Barbadian (Commonwealth citizen).